

The Dhāraṇī of the Tathāgata Who Completely Clears Away All the Lower Realms

Sarvadurgatipariśodhanatathāgatasya Dhāraṇī · Toh 782 · Derge Kangyur

ཅན་སངས་ཐམས་ཅད་ཡངས་ས་སྤྱལ་བའ་དྲི་བེའུ་གཤགས་པའ་གི་ཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī of Complete Purification of All the Lower Realms (in Tibetan, Ngen song thams cad yongs su sel ba'i gzungs) is a short dhāraṇī text that opens with homage to the Tathāgata who completely clears away all the lower realms, and then gives a mantra for purifying the practitioner's negative actions. It teaches that anyone who remembers even a single syllable, word, or name of this dhāraṇī will recall their former lives for a hundred and forty thousand eons, will have all karmic obscurations purified, and will swiftly reach the stage of non-returning, with merit that remains inexhaustible until awakening. A Sanskrit title is not given in the source lines and so is not stated here. The work is Toh 782 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, those brief spoken formulas valued for their protective and purifying power.

Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, who completely clears away all the lower realms.

Tadyathā: Oṃ śodhani viśodhani mama sarva pāpaṃ viśodhani, śuddhe viśuddhe, sarva karma āvaraṇa viśuddhe svāhā.

Son of noble family, or daughter of noble family, whoever holds in memory every syllable, word, or name of this dhāraṇī will recall their former lives for one hundred and forty thousand eons. All karmic obscurations will also be purified, and they will swiftly attain the stage of non-returning. Until they reach the heart of awakening, their merit will never be exhausted.

Thus ends the dhāraṇī called Complete Purification of All the Lower Realms.

Translator's Notes

- The Tibetan renders the dhāraṇī in transliterated Sanskrit, and I have kept it as such; the spelling follows the Tibetan, and Sanskrit forms vary slightly across witnesses. The number rendered "one hundred and forty thousand" is literally "ten thousand times ten thousand... fourteen," that is, 'bum phrag bcu bzhi, which is read here as fourteen hundred-thousands; the figure is conventional in dhāraṇī literature and may differ in other editions. The phrase "stage of non-returning" renders phyir mi ldog pa nyid, the irreversible state, which in context signifies irreversibility on the path to awakening.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.